

Green Ahmedabad

A spanking new 16,000 sq m oxygen park is opening up in Ahmedabad to make the city greener

giving away seeds of trees with our issue. There are agencies that work exclusively with carbon offsetting, which is a process by which you can pay a company to plant the requisite amount of trees to offset the amount of damage you have done to the environment. These are often taken up on a large scale, where thousands of trees are planted at once. We can contribute by personally offsetting the damage that our usage does. To do this, we must know exactly how much damage we inflict.

How much damage do gadgets inflict?

For every purchase we make, there is a lot of garbage, electricity consumption and greenhouse gas emission upstream. This means that when we pick up a package from a store, we are purchasing something that has already damaged the environment a lot, before it has even been used. The mining of aluminum and tin that is used in our gadgets leaves behind a large carbon footprint. Acrylonitrile butadiene styrene (ABS) is a type of thermoplastic commonly used in gadgets, which is also pretty damaging. Small

NOKIA Connecting People We:recycle

Nokia encourages mobile phone users to recycle their old handsets and accessories, **regardless of the brand** and promises to plant a tree for every phone dropped-in during the campaign period in the specified cities.

Nokia has already collected over 3 tons of old phones and accessories a mere **45 days** after the campaign started, and from just **4 cities!**

Do your bit, help save our planet by joining **Planet Ke Rakhwale** Community at www.planetkerakhwale.com, and start recycling today.

amounts of cadmium, copper, steel and other materials used in a gadget come from large industries that pollute the earth in many ways. These raw materials are transported around the world, often across countries, to be converted into

Are Dams green?

India and China remain the only countries to continue to build Dams. This is because old engineering tech is still reaching Asia

CRACK THE CODE

al vlr exsb texq fq qxhbp ql drbpb qeb zlkqbkqp lc qefp ylu rpfkd grpq qeb cobnrkzv lc ibqqbop fk qeb qbuq? lo tfii vlr exsb ql illh lrq clo hbojfb qeb cold pmv bkzlabo xka rpb qeb qlm pbzobq zlab krijbo ql abzovmq qeb mxpptoia – “gxzhxi” – rpfkd qeb krijbop. You need a frog that's good with numbers, and when you meet it, feed it the number 127.

components of devices. The components are often shipped elsewhere for assembly. After the assembly, the devices are packaged, then shipped to stores around the world. This process does not include the environmental harm in designing the components, and all the materials used for promotion and advertising purposes.

The companies that commission or handle all these processes, are acutely aware of the carbon footprint that they are leaving behind. If as a user, you are calculating the environmental karma of each and every gadget you own, the processes responsible for bringing the device to you should ideally not be a burden on you. Companies often offset their carbon footprints by purchasing credits that allow them to pollute up to a certain level. Although the process of getting the gadget to you is disruptive, the damage has already been paid for. This cost is a part of the cost of the device itself, so when you try to offset the carbon footprint, you are responsible only for offsetting the disruptive effects of just the usage of a device.

As you will see on the next page, the materials for a single laptop come from about twenty countries around the world.

Environmentally sound gadget use

If you are using 500 kWh a month in a four person household in India, your carbon footprint for a month is about 0.42 tons of CO₂ every month. However, lifestyle choices for what you use for cooking, heating and fueling your transportation all affect your overall carbon footprint. When it comes to technology, effective usage of your devices can go a considerable way in reducing your footprint. The basic approaches for effective usage are:

What goes into making a gadget?



Step 1: Mining

The raw materials required for a device are mined



Step 2: Transport

The mined materials are transported to manufacturing unit



Step 3: Component manufacture

Items like keys, buttons, track-pads etc are made from the raw materials



Step 4: Device assembly

The device is put together in a plant



Step 5: Distribution

The device is distributed to shops